

# "Heron 2.5: Front strut knock and uneven tire wear from worn strut assembly"

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Area: bulletins

## 1 Condition

Heron 2.5 owners may report a knocking or clunking noise from the front of the vehicle over bumps, accompanied by uneven or feathered tire wear. The condition is most often attributable to a worn front strut assembly STRT-8500 that no longer controls suspension travel adequately. Review the component description in the Heron Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Sub-System before condemning the part. The cross-platform Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Assembly offers additional context on strut construction.

## 2 Cause

Internal damping degradation within strut assembly STRT-8500 allows excess vertical movement, producing the knock under load and accelerating irregular tread wear. Worn mounts and a fatigued spring seat compound the noise as mileage accumulates. The Heron Suspension Service Manual details inspection criteria, and the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Suspension System Overview explains how a failing STRT-8500 transmits forces into the chassis.

## 3 Repair Procedure

Replace front strut assembly STRT-8500 on the affected side, or in axle sets when wear is comparable, following PROC-STRUT as documented in the Heron Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Replacement . The equivalent steps appear in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Replacement Procedure for technicians cross-trained on that platform. After installing the new STRT-8500, perform a four-wheel alignment per PROC-ALIGN using the Lumen Steering Service Manual :: Four-Wheel Alignment Procedure . Road test to confirm the knock is eliminated before returning the vehicle.